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EMIRATES TO CREATE THOUSANDS OF JOBS WITH MEGA ENGINEERING HUB

Dubai South project to open up opportunities for mechanics, engineers, administrators and specialists

\$5.1b
Total project value

1.1m sqm will make it one of the world's largest buildings by volume and the largest steel structure in the GCC

28 WIDE-BODY AIRCRAFT AT ONE TIME
It will be the world's only hangar complex capable of simultaneously servicing 28 Emirates wide-body aircraft

WORLD'S LARGEST DEDICATED LANDING GEAR WORKSHOP

285 METRE FREE-SPAN HANGAR
The world's largest for next-generation maintenance operations

77,000 sqm DEDICATED WORKSHOP SPACE for advanced repairs & maintenance operations

NEXT-GENERATION PAINT HANGARS
Purpose-built facilities capable of servicing Emirates' wide-body fleet, with extra narrow-body capacity

SUSTAINABILITY

LEED PLATINUM-RATED BUILDINGS

ROOFTOP SOLAR PV PANELS

DEDICATED ADMINISTRATIVE BUILDING
Supporting Emirates Engineering operations with:

50,000 sqm of office space

15,000 sqm of training facilities

INTEGRATED GATEWAY FACILITY
controlling airspace access

PROJECT COMPLETION BY MID-2030

SEE ALSO P8

UAE sets monthly salary deadline for private sector

Authorities outline a series of escalating penalties for payment delays starting June 1

DUBAI
BY KHITAM AL AMIR
Chief News Editor

The Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization (MoHRE) has issued a new rule requiring private sector firms to pay employee salaries on the first day of every month beginning June 1, as part of efforts to strengthen wage protection and labour compliance.

Under Ministerial Resolution No. 340 of 2026, salaries for the previous month must be transferred through the approved Wage Protection System (WPS) or any other payment systems authorised by the ministry. Any payment made after the due date will be considered delayed.

The ministry said all private sector establishments registered with it would also be required to provide documents and data proving salary payments in accordance with approved regulations.

The new rules define a company as compliant if it transfers at least 85 per cent of the total wages to workers on time. An employee will not be considered unpaid if they receive at least 85 per cent of their salary and the remaining amount re-

sults from legally documented deductions. Authorities outlined a series of penalties for late payments, beginning with electronic monitoring and warning notices from the second day after salaries become due.

Suspension

From the fifth day of delay, companies could face suspension of new work permits, with employers formally notified of the violations and required to settle unpaid wages. Additional administrative fines under existing cabinet regulations would apply from the 11th day if violations are repeated within six months, alongside the downgrading of offending companies into the third business classification category.

If delays continue beyond the 16th day, affected workers may have individual or collective labour disputes registered on their behalf, while further work permit suspensions may be imposed. The ministry said harsher penalties would apply from the 21st day of delay, including referrals to public prosecutors for companies employing 50 workers or more in cases of repeated violations.

Authorities may also issue enforcement orders to recover unpaid wages, impose precautionary asset seizures and travel bans on responsible company officials, while notifying other government entities to take legal measures.

OUR RESOLVE ONLY GROWS STRONGER: UAE

No one will twist UAE's arm, Gargash says after Barakah attack

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE will keep building. Our resolve only grows stronger.

With those words, Dr Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber, Minister of Industry and Advanced Technology, yesterday underscored the UAE's response to a terrorist attack targeting the Barakah Nuclear Power Plant — a strike the country said was aimed not only at critical infrastructure, but also at its vision of security, stability and progress.

The UAE stressed that the targeting of Barakah represented “a terrorist attack on a peaceful project, built to the highest safety standards, that powers homes, hospitals, and industries across the nation.”

Attack on a nation's right

Dr Al Jaber added that the aggression was “also an attack on the right of every nation to build, to progress, and to deliver clean energy to its people.”

The Federal Authority for Nuclear Regulation (FANR) stressed that the incident did not affect the safety of the nuclear plant or the readiness of its essential systems.

“There has been no release of radioactive material, radiological safety levels remain within normal ranges, and there is no risk to the public or

No one will succeed in undermining UAE's vision, its success, and its inspiring message of security, stability, development and prosperity to the peoples of the region.”

Dr Anwar Mohammed Gargash
Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President

the environment,” FANR said. “Barakah will keep running. The UAE will keep building. Our resolve only grows stronger,” the Minister said.

Dr Anwar Mohammed Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, describing the attack as “a dangerous escalation and a dark act that violates all international laws and norms.”

In a post on X, Gargash said the attack, “whether carried out by the principal perpetrator or through one of its agents,” reflected “criminal disregard for the lives of civilians in the UAE and its surroundings.”

He added that the escalation reaffirmed the scale of the

challenge facing the region in confronting “the forces of evil, chaos and sabotage.”

“No one will twist the UAE's arm, nor will they succeed in undermining its vision, its success, and its inspiring message of security, stability, development and prosperity to the peoples of the region,” Gargash emphasised.

Strong condemnation

The attack drew strong condemnation from regional allies including Saudi Arabia, Kuwait, Bahrain and Oman, all of which reaffirmed solidarity with the UAE. Separately, the UAE also condemned drone attacks targeting Saudi Arabia after Riyadh said it intercepted and destroyed three drones that entered its airspace from Iraq late Sunday.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs affirmed the UAE's “full solidarity” with Saudi Arabia and support for all measures aimed at safeguarding the Kingdom's security and stability.

Iraq's foreign ministry later said its air defence systems had not detected any drones launched from Iraqi territory and announced an investigation into the incident.

The ministry urged Riyadh “to cooperate and share relevant information to help ensure accurate information that strengthen security and stability in both brotherly countries.”

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MORE PASSING THROUGH

Hormuz tanker traffic edges higher after wartime low

LONDON

Traffic through the Strait of Hormuz was slightly higher last week, returning to levels in line with the average recorded since the start of the Middle East conflict after hitting a wartime low.

A total of 55 commodities vessels crossed the strategic waterway between May 11 and 17, according to data from maritime tracking firm Kpler as of yesterday morning.

That marked a sharp increase from the previous week, when just 19 vessels crossed — the lowest weekly figure since the first US-Israeli strikes on Iran on February 28, which led to widespread disruption of traffic through the strait.

Iranian state television said Friday the Revolutionary Guards were allowing more ships to transit the strait, after reporting a day earlier that “more than 30 ships” had been permitted to pass. Despite the increase, last week's crossings remain broadly in line with wartime averages.

Since March 1, Kpler has recorded 663 commodity vessels transiting the strait, 55 per week on average.

Around half the tankers crossing last week carried liquids. These included three very large crude carriers, reportedly bound for China, Oman and Japan.

Kpler data also showed 15 dry bulk commodity vessels and 16 liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) tankers crossed the strait last week.

Only one liquefied natural gas tanker carrying Qatari gas to Pakistan crossed, on May 12.

That brought the total number of LNG tanker crossings since the start of the war to eight.

Iran has repeatedly warned that maritime traffic through the shipping lane would “not return to its pre-war status”.

Yesterday, Tehran announced the creation of a new body to oversee the strait and charge vessels for transiting the waterway, which Iran has reportedly been doing since early on in the war.

— AFP

BUSINESS

UAE Cabinet approves framework for Agentic AI rollout | P7

INDIA

New Kerala CM Satheesan rolls out welfare blitz on Day 1 in office | P12

WORLD

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